

ICC RANKING: **8th**

BEST WC PERFORMANCE SUPER SIX (2009)

STRENGTHS

Pakistan arrives at the World Cup on the back of an unbeaten Qualifier campaign at home, winning all five matches with comfort. The top order was powered by Sidra Amin, Muneeba Ali, and Aliya Riaz, each chipping in with half-centuries. Captain Fatima Sana added balance with bat and ball, while Nashra Sandhu led a disciplined spin unit well suited to subcontinental tracks.

WEAKNESSES

Despite momentum from the Qualifier, long-standing batting frailties remain. The absence of a settled opening partner for Muneeba exposes instability at the top, while the lower order lacks finishing depth. Heavy reliance on Sidra and Aliya for runs, coupled with the retirements of Bismah Maroof and Javeria Khan, leaves the batting order thin. Fielding lapses and a struggle for timely breakthroughs add to Pakistan's vulnerabilities.

OPPORTUNITIES

This World Cup gives Pakistan a chance to fast-track transition under a young captain. Fatima's rise as a leader and all-rounder offers the side a fresh identity. With Nashra nearing 100 wickets and spinners like Sadia Iqbal and Rameen Shamim providing support, Pakistan has the chance to redefine itself as a spin-dominant unit capable of dictating terms in familiar conditions.

THREATS

Inexperience in leadership and squad depth could be exposed against stronger opposition. Without Nida Dar's wicket-taking presence, pressure on the spin attack intensifies. The pace unit, led by Diana Baig and Fatima, often struggles to strike early, leaving too much for the spinners to repair. If the batting collapses under pressure, the lack of fielding sharpness may magnify the slide.

PREDICTION

If batting depth and fielding improve, the side has the potential to clear the group stage and test stronger opponents.

Kavita Menon

COACH
MOHAMMAD WASIM

CAPTAIN
FATIMA SANA